.1 the procedure to be followed by the master or other persons having charge of the ship to report an oil pollution incident, as required in article 8 and Protocol I of the present Convention, based on guidelines developed by the Organization~/;

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SOURCE: MEPC.54(32).pdf
.1 the procedure to be followed by the master or other persons having charge of the ship to report an oil pollution incident, as required in article 8 and Protocol I of the present Convention, based on guidelines developed by the Organization~/;
~I Reference is made to "General principles for ship reporting system and ship reporting requirements, including Guidelines for reporting incidents involving dangerous goods, harmful substances andlor marine pollutants" adopted by the Organization by resolution A.648(16). For ease of reference, see IMO publication "Provisions concerning the Reporting of Incidents Involving Harmful Substances under MAR POL 73/78".
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. 2 the list of authorities or persons to be contacted in the event of an oil pollution incident;
.3 a detailed description of the action to be taken immediately by persons on board to reduce or control the discharge of oil following the incident; and
.4 the procedures and point of contact on the ship for co-ordinating

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SOURCE: MEPC.54(32).pdf
.3 a detailed description of the action to be taken immediately by persons on board to reduce or control the discharge of oil following the incident; and
.4 the procedures and point of contact on the ship for co-ordinating shipboard activities with national and local authorities in combating the pollution.
2.3 The coastal State report: Article 8 and Protocol I of the Convention require that the nearest coastal State be notified of actual or probable discharges. The intent of this requirement is to ensure that coastal States are informed without delay, of any incident giving rise to pollution, or threat of pollution, of the marine environment, as well as of assistance and salvage measures, so that appropriate action may be taken.
2.3.1 When required: The Plan should provide clear, concise guidance to enable the master to determine when a report to the coastal State is required.
2.3.1.1 Actual discharge: A report to the nearest coastal State is required whenever there is:
. 1 a discharge of oil, resulting from damage to the ship or its equipment, or for the purpose of securing the safety of a ship or saving life at sea; or

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SOURCE: MEPC.54(32).pdf
whenever there is:
. 1 a discharge of oil, resulting from damage to the ship or its
equipment, or for the purpose of securing the safety of a ship
or saving life at sea; or
.2 a discharge during the operation of the ship of oil in excess of
the quantity or instantaneous rate permitted under the present
Convention.
2.3.1.2 Probable discharge: The Plan should give the master guidance to
evaluate a situation which, though not involving an actual discharge, would
qualify as a probable discharge and thus require a report. In jUdging whether
there is such a probability and whether the report should be made, the
following factors, as a minimwn, should be taken into account:
.1 the nature of the damage, failure or breakdown of the ship,
machinery or equipment;
. 2 ship location and proximity to land or other navigational hazards;
. 3 weather, tide, current and sea state; and
.4 traffic density.
2.3.1.2.1 It is impracticable to lay down precise definitions of all types of
situations involving probable discharge which would warrant an obligation to
report. As a general guideline, the master should make a report in cases of:

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SOURCE: MEPC.54(32).pdf
2.3.1.2.1 It is impracticable to lay down precise definitions of all types of
situations involving probable discharge which would warrant an obligation to
report. As a general guideline, the master should make a report in cases of:
. 1 damage, failure or breakdown which affects the safety of ships;
examples of such situations are collision, grounding, fire,
explosion, structural failure, flooding, cargo shifting; and
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.2 failure or breakdown of machinery or equipment which results in
impairment of the safety of navigation: examples of such incidents
are failure or breakdown of steering gear, propulsion, electrical
generating system, essential shipborne navigational aids.
2.3.2 Information required: The Plan must specify, in appropriate detail,
tbe procedure for making the initial report to the coastal State. The
Organization's guidelines in resolution A.648(16) provide necessary detail for
the Plan writer. The Plan should include a prepared message form, an example

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SOURCE: MEPC.54(32).pdf
tbe procedure for making the initial report to the coastal State. The

Organization's guidelines in resolution A.648(16) provide necessary detail for the Plan writer. The Plan should include a prepared message form, an example of which is included at Appendix II to these Guidelines. Coastal States are encouraged to take note of table 1 of Appendix II and accept this as sufficient initial information. Supplementary or follow-up reports should as far as possible use the same format.
2.4 List of persons to be contacted
2.4.1 The ship involved in a pollution incident will have to communicate with both coastal State or port contacts and ship interests contacts.
2.4.2 When compiling contact lists, due account must be taken of the need to provide 24-hour contact information and to provide alternates to the designated contact. These details must be routinely updated to take account of personnel changes and changes in telephone, telex, and telefax numbers. Clear guidance should also be provided regarding the preferred means of communication (telex, telephone, telefax, etc.)
2.4.3 Coastal State contacts

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of personnel changes and changes in telephone, telex, and telefax numbers. Clear guidance should also be provided regarding the preferred means of communication (telex, telephone, telefax, etc.)
2.4.3 Coastal State contacts
2.4.3.1 In order to expedite response and m1n1m1ze damage from a pollution incident, it is essential that appropriate coastal States be notified without delay. This process is begun with the initial report required by article 8 and Protocol I of the Convention. Guidelines for making this report are provided in paragraph 2.3.
2.4.3.2 The Plan should include as an appendix the list of agencies or officials of administrations responsible for receiving and processing reports as developed and updated by the Organization in conformance with article 8 of the Convention. In the absence of a listed focal point, or should any undue delay be experienced in contacting the responsible authority by direct means, the master should be advised to contact the nearest coastal radio station, designated ship movement reporting station or Rescue Co-ordination Centre (RCC) by the quickest available means.
2.4.4 Port contacts

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the master should be advised to contact the nearest coastal radio station, designated ship movement reporting station or Rescue Co-ordination Centre (RCC) by the quickest available means.
2.4.4 Port contacts
2.4.4.1 For ships in port, notification of local agencies will speed response. The variety of trades in which ships engage makes it impractical to specify in these guidelines a definitive approach to listing these agencies in the Plan. Information on regularly visited ports should be included as an appendix to the Plan. Where this is not feasible, the Plan should require the master to obtain details concerning local reporting procedures upon arriving in port.

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2.4.5.1 The Plan should provide details of all parties with an interest in the ship to be advised in the event of an incident. This information should be provided in the form of a contact list. When compiling such lists, it should be remembered that in the event of a serious incident, ship's personnel

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the ship to be advised in the event of an incident. This information should be provided in the form of a contact list. When compiling such lists, it should be remembered that in the event of a serious incident, ship's personnel will be fully engaged in saving life and taking steps to control and minimize the effects of the casualty. They should therefore not be hampered by having onerous communications requirements imposed on them.
2.4.5.2 Procedures will vary between companies but it is important that the Plan clearly specifies who will be responsible for informing the various